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The new one-way rule in Adyar exists only on paper

A. UMA ARUN

Some weeks ago, the Greater Chennai Traffic Police implemented a one-way traffic arrangement from Lattice Bridge Road to Shastri Nagar First Avenue through First Main Road to facilitate metro rail work.

As per the arrangement, motorists from Mahatma Gandhi Road entering Indira Nagar First Avenue and a section of Lattice Bridge Road (towards Adyar) have to take a U-turn along a residential apartment on the



Bridge Road lane towards Thiruvannamiyur.

But motorists displace the barricades on Mahatma Gandhi Road and enter Lattice Bridge Road and Indira

Nagar First Avenue.

The flow of traffic is affected on Lattice Bridge Road towards Mahatma Gandhi Road and a section along Adyar Depot.

Motorists on Mahatma Gandhi Road take a U-turn to enter the lane towards Shastri Nagar First Main Road. Also, motorists from Indira Nagar First Avenue drive to Thiruvannamiyur.

Buses can be allowed from the Adyar Bus Depot towards IT Corridor and Tambaram regions, and from Mahatma Gandhi Road towards the Depot, as taking a U-turn on Mahatma Gandhi Road and Lattice Bridge Road can result in traffic bottlenecks.

A. Uma Arun is a resident of Indira Nagar



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A think group in Padur

The Knowledge Circle initiated at a gated community, XS Real Harmony, welcomes the communities around to join them



Participants of the first session.

The Knowledge Circle, a community initiative powered by ZenManam, was inaugurated at XS Real Harmony, a gated community in Padur, on August 23, coinciding with National Space Day.

The initiative aims to encourage reading, scientific curiosity, critical thinking and knowledge sharing among children, teenagers and adults through regular meet-ups featuring book discussions, science

and research conversations, activities, games and interactions with guest speakers.

The inaugural gathering featured an online talk on “The Universe” by astrophysicist and space weather researcher Sarath Prabhavu J. The evening concluded with a sky-observation session, where participants viewed the moon through an eight-inch Dobsonian telescope.

The Knowledge Circle plans to

hold regular community meet-ups under its continuing “Orbit” series, bringing together people across age groups to read, question, explore, verify and share. A book reading session is also planned. It welcomes residents from in and around Padur to join them. The sessions are free, and will feature people from different domains engaging with participants.

For details, contact Vijay Alagarsamy at 9952093233

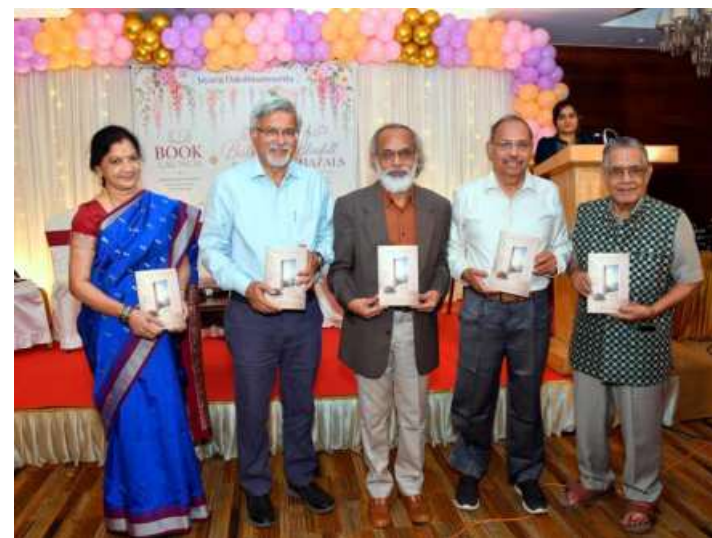
Book launch by Besant Nagar resident

The book titled *Sharp Insights Short Writeups* written by Besant Nagar resident Jayaraj Dakshinamoorthy and published through Notion Press was launched on August 25, 2026 at a function at Radha Krishna Hall at Matsya Restaurant in Adyar.

The book was formally released by Vinay Kamath, senior associate editor (retired) of *The Hindu Businessline*. Vinay Kamath was engaged on a one-to-one discussion with the author bringing out the salient features

of the book that delves into various human traits in the context of mind and matter, perceptions and deceptions, self romance and societal demands, says a press release.

The book fits into the self-help genre. It can be of immense help to the younger generation who need new perspectives to handle old issues confronting them. The function ended with a delicious dinner while the author was enthralled the audience with his soulful ghazal singing, the release adds.



At the launch.

Every second Saturday, this book club meets in Thoraipakkam

Every meetup holds a book and a movie up to critical scrutiny

Recently, Koodam Spaces, a community event and coworking space in Thoraipakkam, saw over 40 people gather to read Veyilodu Poi by S. Thamizhselvan and watch select scenes from the movie *Poo*, directed by Sasi. The conversation was both simple and profound, pushing people to deep dive into emotions, stories and experiences for almost four hours. Every second Saturday, Koodam Spaces witnesses this energy, brought on by the Ilakkiyakurangul Book Club community.

Started by Krithi Mohan and Arun Selvan, development sector professionals, Koodam Spaces was started to bring a sense of community. The Ilakkiyakurangul Book Club was conceived by Bharani Dharan Palanivel, along with Annie, and Kishore Prasath Khiran. It is an offline extension of the Ilakkiyakurangul YouTube channel, which comes under Vijay Varadharaj's Temple Monkeys, one of the early pio-



neers of the Tamil YouTube space.

The channel started with an intent to encourage its audience to discover new genres of literature and film. The Book Club grew from the same idea, but this time the conversation shifted from a screen to a physical space where people could experience stories and ideas together. Each session brings together a book and a movie based on or inspired by it.



From some of the recent meet-ups.

The Book Club's previous sessions have explored works such as *The Little Prince*, Dostoevsky's *White Nights*, Vaikom Muhammad Basheer's *Mathilukal*, and Sujatha's *For The Position*. Each time, the conversations often move beyond their book and movie themselves. A character's decision can lead to a discussion about choices we make in our own lives.

The Book Club keeps its sessions small and affordable. The hope is that people leave having read something new, heard a different point of view, questioned an idea, or perhaps looked at a familiar part of their own life a little differently, added the release.

For upcoming sessions and glimpses of the Book Club's conversations, find them on YouTube and Instagram: @ilakkiyakurangul.

Have an idea to bring people together, need a space to work out of, or planning a private gathering? Explore Koodam Spaces, Thoraipakkam. Contact +91 9500 54 52 54 for enquiries. Instagram: @koodamchennai



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Book pieces together Madras society



Madras Day was celebrated in an Adyar bookstore on August 22, 2026, with the launch of Kodambakkam resident N. Meera Raghavendra Rao's book *Madras Mosaic* by architect and convener of the Chennai chapter of INTACH, Sujatha Shankar.

The first copy was received by

former Chief Election Commissioner T.S. Krishnamurthy.

During the lively, witty interaction that followed with the author, Sujatha Shankar said anybody could relate to the incidents mentioned in the book that has been republished after 20 years.

While Meera Rao, author of 12 books and numerous articles, interviews and book reviews in leading newspapers and magazines, elaborated on how she got into writing, Sujatha Shankar mentioned two chapters in the book that she could easily relate to.

One was about the life of construction workers, and the other was about how the mother-in-law gets a culture shock while visiting a five-star hotel in a nine-yard saris. Sujatha Shankar recalled how her aunts played tennis in their madisar saris.

'Better policing needed on Sardar Patel Road'



G. SAMUEL GODWIN

A section of Sardar Patel Road in Guindy region needs policing. On the lane towards Madhya Kailash, motorists change direction to access Gandhi Mandapam flyover.

Near the flyover entry lane, during rush hour, to avoid getting

caught in slow-moving traffic, motorists swerve left, suddenly speed, then swerve right to access the flyover, startling their counterparts.

The flyover entry lane is narrow, and speeding can lead to collisions. A similar chaos is witnessed at the entry lane; motorists from Sardar Patel Road (from Guindy National

Park), from opposite Anna University, and from Gandhi Mandapam Road access the flyover and drive along it to enter the lane towards Little Mount.

Policing on the flyover to curb rash driving and overtaking is a must.

G. Samuel Godwin is a resident of Guindy

A triumph both on and off the goalball court

Greater awareness about goalball needs to be created so that the visually challenged take it up

LIFY THOMAS

Viewed at a surface level, the Tamil Nadu team's great showing in the Indian Blind Sports Association's "Second Youth National Goalball Championship 2026", where it took the second place, is just another victory in a sporting arena. At a deeper level, this victory signals other victories.

For one, it is a victory for the Goalball Association of Tamil Nadu, a registered body just a year old, for its successful efforts to stitch together a team comprising visually impaired students from small towns and difficult economic backgrounds. Many of them look at sports as a ticket to a stable government job.

R. Barath, a final year student of Presidency College, grew up in a joint family in Erode. His single father and uncle are visually challenged. Just three months ago, he learnt about the sport from a friend and got selected to the state team. "There are many blind students like me at Presidency College, Queen Mary's College and Nandanam Arts College. Conducting awareness sessions about this sport will encourage many more to join it and benefit them the way I have," he says

A short put and javelin thrower, Ahilendiran D from Madurai got to know about goalball from his



coach. An orphan, Ahilendiran supports his family taking up part-time jobs. After this victory, he hopes they get to compete in recognised competitions and more people and organisations come forward to sponsor them as well. Rajasthan Youth Association Foundation sponsored them for the just-concluded event.

A judo coach for the blind, V. Maheswaran from Salem was

roped in to coach the boys team noticing the interest he showed in the para sport. He picked up the sport watching videos online and with the help of his son. "We all are learning and getting better with every competition. When we had the selection camp in Chennai, we sought help from members of Telangana team," says Maheswaran. Proud that three of his judo students have landed government



From a recent competition and the team that won the second place at the national tournament.

jobs, he says, sports is not a level-playing field especially for those with disabilities and more organisations should come to empower students to take up sports.

For the national tournament, participants have to wear an eye patch but each costs more than ₹ 3,000, so we just tied a black cloth and played, he says.

Finding new talent

Visually challenged G.R. Bharathi Raja, who started the Tamil Nadu Blind Football Association in 2019, is also coaching students in goalball. He says goalball is specially designed for those with vision problems and teaches players life skills, builds physical strength and helps with coordination.

The Association is looking at

conducting more awareness workshops in schools and colleges about goalball. Their first workshop had 45 students participating in it. "We are happy to visit institutions with visually challenged students to conduct more sessions and groom a new generation of players," says Bharathi Raja, who works with Indian Bank.

Besides accessible facilities to play and practise, the sport needs support on many other fronts.

Vidyashankar B, chairperson, Goalball Association of Tamil Nadu, wants the State Government to reward players who win national and international tournaments with cash awards.

Bringing players together at one space is a challenge. "If every district allots a space in a stadium for goalball then it saves the travel time, cost incurred for food and accommodation for many of these players who come from humble backgrounds," says Vidyashankar, who works with an IT company and is grateful to the support from Lit the Light Trust where he was a volunteer.

Finally, for players with visual disabilities it is not just about winning medals but to show to the world they can compete in a para sport.

The history of it

Invented in 1946 as a rehabilitation sport for visually impaired World War II veterans, the sport evolved into a competitive discipline and gained international recognition. In 1976, Goalball was officially introduced as a Paralympic sport at the Toronto Paralympic Games. Played by two teams of three players each in an indoor court that roughly measures the size of a volleyball court (18mx9m), goalball relies on auditory skills, teamwork and tactical awareness. A bell inside the ball allows players to track movement through sound. All players wear opaque eye masks to allow players with varying degree of blindness to compete on an equal footing. Players roll or throw the ball hard along the floor to get it past the opposing team's defence and into a 9-metre-wide goal. Today, goalball is played in more than 100 countries and is said to be one of the most inspiring team sports in the Paralympic movement. For details, visit <https://tngoalball.in/> or call 93449 87893



A dish's biodata

Here is Atho's biodata. Street food. Born in Burma. Naturalised in Madras. It is a hugely spicy form of noodles paired with shredded vegetables and the spiciness comes from a range of flavourings, which include chilli flakes, garlic, tamarind and fried onion. There is poetry to how it is made: the noodles along with its pairings is tossed by hand.

Atho is a gift Indians repatriated from Burma gave to Madras, their new home. And by owning and relishing this dish, Madras gave them a sense of connection with their past, people and culture as return gift

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

People marry into money. Abdul Rahman married into "Atho". And the latter situation translates to money saved by the plates. "I have never had to pay for a plate of Atho after marriage," Rahman chuckles.

Rahman is the son-in-law of Abdul Ajeez, whose eponymous Ajeez Atho Shop at Arrababu Street off Rajaji Salai in George Town has the effect of a speed governor on an environment geared to movement and bustle. The milling crowd on Rajaji Salai contrasts with the stationary, slurping crowd around Ajeez's shop. Customers, their work bags slung over their shoulders, tuck into plates of Atho as if it were their comfort food.

Atho shops in this part of George Town present these two scenarios. Local residents "own" Atho as one would a home-grown dish, treating it as a gift from Madras; a good number of them are likely unaware of the Burma backstory. And those Indians who left Burma (now Myanmar) for Madras find that connection with the Burma of the past sustained through Atho's popularity in this city. Through it, they also enjoy a sense of community among their own. Take these illustrations.

At Arrababu Street, Ajeez Atho Shop is at a vantage point enjoying

clear visibility from Rajaji Salai but patronage does not derive entirely from that factor. Rahman observes that with Ajeez, selling Atho has never merely been a business. With parents having lived in Burma, and leaving it behind for India, specifically Madras, as repatriates following the coup d'état in 1962, Ajeez views making and selling Atho as a bridge to his culture and people. This passion runs in the family. Rahman notes that his relatives operate similar Atho stalls in Trichy and Kutralam, further reinforcing food's known status as a mark of culture and community.

Legacy food should have secret recipes. Rahman insists there is no secret recipe; the true craft lies entirely in the balance of mixing and proportion. The shop caters to every craving with its main varieties: vegetarian, fried, and egg Atho, each customised to individual spice tolerances. Crucially, vegetarian and non-vegetarian preparation areas are kept strictly separate, ensuring no one's dietary preferences are compromised.

Ajeez operates from this spot for 20 years but has been in the Atho business for twice that number of years. After 40 years, he has found allies in his sons, Haider Ali and Yusuf. "On days my father-in-law is out of station or not well, his sons take care of the stall," observes Rahman.

And Rahman points out he does not assist in the running of the shop, just content being an avid Atho taster. And also volunteering to be a spokesperson, as he did for

Naturalised in Madras



Ajeez Atho Shop at Arrababu Street; and Shahul Hameed's shop at Second Line Beach Road in George Town.

this interview. Rahman points out the stall has appeared on several media platforms and attracted many VIPs who visit the stall during the less crowded hours.

Blurring of hierarchies

Shahul Hameed is the boss, and he is aged 30. Vincent Alphonse reports to Shahul at his Atho stall on Second Line Beach Road, and is more than twice his boss' age, having been born in 1962. The usual

hierarchical boss-worker relationship is missing. Deference to age does not entirely account for this behaviour. Shared histories and family connections explain it better. The forbears of both men are from Burma having come to Madras as repatriates following the 1962 coup. Repatriates Khadija Beevi and her husband started this shop 45 years ago and handed over its reins to their son Shahul. They have made sure their trusted lieute-

nant Vincent Alphonse who has worked with them for 30 years, is by their son's side assisting him. When his parents arrived in Madras from Burma in 1965, Alphonse was three years old, and his siblings were also children of tender years. Probably due to the effect of shared histories and family bonds and age, Shahul lets Vincent do the talking. One thing Vincent holds close to his heart is the customers telling him how conspicuous his absence is on the days he is not present in the shop. The cart draws bankers, lawyers, and college students, serving them vegetable, chicken, and fried Atho, alongside mohinga noodles traditionally accompanied by soup and banana stem. Vincent however notes mohinga has never matched Altho's popularity. Vincent says the secret of a good Atho moves far beyond its cooking process; it is in the mixing. Every component must come together correctly for the taste to emerge perfectly. He remarks fried atho is an entirely Indian twist to the Burmese dish. The cart employs around five people for smooth functioning. The sales dip during periods of religious abstinence from non-vegetarian food, but vegetable Atho sufficiently fills the gap and, Vincent says, has the highest demand. Vincent's composed voice could not hide his immense pride as he spoke about how the shop received a Vijay TV award for Best Navu (Meal) in 2012, an honour he credits to their taste. He adds that the shop holds an FSSAI certification, with employees having participated in food safety meetings.

Further down Second Line Beach Road, another Atho stall, called Burma Atho Shop, carries the same sense of a legacy being passed on. Rahamathulla took over the business from his uncle who had learnt the art of making Atho in Burma. And he makes it the way his uncle taught him. However, along the way, he has also tweaked Atho to suit local taste buds. His menu has grown to nearly 10 choices, spanning vegetable and fried Atho, including chicken and egg versions, with customers able to adjust the spice and flavours to their liking. And thereby he enables Burma, Madras and Chennai coexist, defying the limitations of time and geography.

As part of Madras Week, Resilience Series tracks traders and markets that have adapted to changing times and thrived in the city that was once called Madras



An open well in Besant Nagar.

FILE PHOTO: KARUNAKARAN M

With the right design, an open well need not be a space taker; it can instead offer space for parking or anything else in addition to providing water-related benefits, as these communities in Chennai discovered with the help of The Rain Centre

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

For many apartment residents in Chennai, an open well may sound like something from another time – a structure with a parapet wall, a pulley and a bucket. With space at a premium, keeping one may seem impractical. But an open well does not necessarily mean giving up a parking spot or valuable open space. With the right design, it can be built below ground, allowing vehicles to pass over it while the well continues to collect rainwater and recharge groundwater.

This is what N. Ramshankar, an executive member of The Rain Centre, has done at the Rain Centre in Adyar. An old open well that once had only about two feet of water now holds around 16 feet after rooftop rainwater was direct-

Park your car over your open well

ed into it with minimal filtration.

Sekhar Raghavan, director, The Rain Centre, weighs in about this open well on the premises of the Rain Centre: “Unless I open the lid, you will not even know that there is an open well below.” Such wells can even be incorporated into driveways or parking areas, Sekhar says, provided they are kept away from structural columns. “You can have your open well within your stilt car parking,” says Sekhar. The minimum space required for the well, according to him, is about 3.25 feet in diameter.

“We were afraid in the initial days. We were wondering whether an open well can be closed and whether it will accumulate gas and all that. An engineer told us, ‘Don’t make that mistake, nothing will happen.’ He even set up a vent for us,” says Ramshankar. The parapet wall was subsequently removed and a slab was placed at floor level. “We demolished the parapet wall of the well and then we put a slab on it, at the floor level. Now we have vehicles going on top of it,” he says.

The benefit has not been limited to saving space. The quality of

the water has also improved. “The TDS has also been diluted from almost 850 to now 400,” he says.

For Ramshankar, the value of an open well lies in what it can provide while also being replenished. Open wells generally tap the shallow aquifer, around 25 to 30 feet below the ground and, at most, about 40 feet. Unlike the deeper hard-rock aquifer tapped by borewells, this shallow groundwater can be replenished more easily through rainwater harvesting. Rooftop rainwater can be directed into an existing well, replenishing the water and helping dilute salts and TDS.

Sekhar Raghavan says open wells generally tap the shallow groundwater layer, which can be replenished through rainwater harvesting.

“During monsoon, your open well will have a lot of water, and a couple of months thereafter. So,

We made these collection pits at every gate and diverted the water to the percolation pits.

start tapping it. Then during summer months, go to your borewell,” he says. For an apartment, this can also translate into a reduction in dependence on tanker water.

Keeping the tankers away

At Hiranya Apartments in Raja Annamalaipuram, resident Raghunandan Ranganathan says the open well was never shut, even though three borewells had been installed and two were later closed. “This open well is what is giving us a lot of water,” he says.

The apartment already had rainwater-harvesting infrastructure, including percolation wells. But during heavy rain, water would collect in the compound and flow out through the gates onto the road. The residents then sought Sekhar Raghavan's help.

“We made these collection pits at every gate and diverted the water to the percolation pits, which in turn were feeding the well,” says Raghunandan. Over time, the system changed the quality and availability of water in the apartment.

“Builders often do not make use of the open wells available on

a property. Instead, they tend to shut them down and install borewells. I am not able to understand the logic behind this.”

Making use of the monsoon

At Bayview Apartments in Besant Nagar, the open well has been in use since the apartment was built around 1989-90. “We are using an open well. Generally, during the rain, mainly after the Northeast Monsoon, it fills up,” says resident K. Sangameshwar.

The apartment also has two borewells and a Metro Water connection. During the rainy season, residents use more of the open well and borewell. Rainwater from the terrace is directed towards the ground, with parts of the system leading close to the open well. The complex also has rainwater-harvesting pits in its open areas. “So all these go into the well, and from the well, I think it slowly percolates into the groundwater,” says Sangameshwar.

Unlike the well at The Rain Centre, the Bayview well remains above ground, with a cover and mesh over it. It shows that there is no single way for an apartment to retain an open well. It can remain visible in an open space, or it can be covered and integrated into a driveway or parking area.

For apartment residents, then, the question may not be whether there is enough space for an open well. It could be whether the space already available can be put to better use – above the ground for parking, and below it for water

Chennai Counselors Foundation launches book



The Chennai Counselors Foundation (CCF), a professional body dedicated to supporting and strengthening the counselling profession and its practitioners, launched the second volume of its publication, Counseling Approaches 2, at an event held on August 22 in Adyar.

The book was formally released by Dr. Vijay Nagaswami, renowned psychiatrist, marital therapist and author, who has written extensively on relationships, marriage and emotional wellbeing. The first copy of the book was received by Archana Prasad, Principal of M.O.P. Vaishnav College for Women, in the presence of members of the counsell-

ing and mental health community and other distinguished guests.

Counseling Approaches 2 brings together perspectives on different approaches to counselling, reflecting the diversity of thought and practice within the profession. The publication is part of CCF's ongoing efforts to encourage professional learning, knowledge-sharing and

Dignitaries at the event.

greater visibility for the work of counsellors, said a release.

A highlight of the occasion was also the launch of the CCF Lifetime Achievement Award, instituted to recognise individuals who have made a significant and sustained contribution to the field. D. Sugan Chinna Maran, Head of Operations and Training at the Tamil Nadu APEX Skill Development Center for Healthcare (TN APEX), was the distinguished guest who presided over the launch of the award.

The Chennai Counselors Foundation, which has a membership of over 150 mental health professionals, works towards promoting professional development, ethical practice, peer learning and greater awareness of counselling as an essential component of mental healthcare, added the release.

Televisions with RGB technology

Sony launched its latest 'Bravia True RGB Televisions' at an event held at Girias Showroom in Mahalingapuram.

Sony is committed to delivering superior picture quality and an immersive viewing experience through its innovative True RGB technology, said a release.

To celebrate the festive season, the multinational conglomerate has announced a special promotional offer on its newly launched Bravia True RGB televisions.

Customers can avail attractive cashback offers, a 1-EMI-free scheme, and a complimentary three-year warranty. The new Bravia True RGB Televisions are now available at Girias showrooms, the release added.

Special trains between Tambaram and Velankanni

The following special trains will be operated to clear the extra rush of passengers during the Annai Velankanni Festival.

Train No. 06037 Tambaram - Velankanni weekly express special will leave Tambaram at 23.50 p.m., on 24th and 31st August, and 07th September (Monday), and reach Velankanni at 07.45 a.m. the next day.

In the return direction,

Train No. 06038 Velankanni - Tambaram weekly express special will leave Velankanni at 00.45 a.m. on 26th August, and 02nd, and 09th September (Wednesday), and reach Tambaram at 07.30 a.m. the next day.

The trains will stop at Chengalpattu, Villupuram, Cuddalore Port, Chidambaram, Mayiladuthurai, Thirunallaru, Karaikal, Nagore, and Nagapattinam.

Janmashtami celebrations

ISKCON, East Coast Road will celebrate Sri Krishna Janmashtami on September 3 (Adivas) and 4 (Janmashtami).

The celebrations will be held from 6:30 p.m. on September 3; on September 4, from 4:30 a.m.

September 3, 6:30 p.m., Sandhya Arati; 7 p.m., 'Adivas' ceremony; 04, 4:30 a.m., 'Mangala Arati'; 7:15 a.m., 'Srimad Bhagavatam' class; 8 a.m., 'Darshan Arati and Guru Puja'; 10 a.m., 'Abhishekam Seva and Kiritan Mela'; 10.20 p.m., 'Maha Abhishekam'; 05, 12 a.m., 'Maha Arati and Anukalpa Prasadam'. The live coverage can be viewed on www.youtube.com/@ISKCON.Chennai

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Coding their way to confidence

From village classrooms to a State-level competition at IIT-M Research Park, young minds are making their mark with digital skills

KANNAL ACHUTHAN

When Iniyasri, a school student from Uthukottai in Thiruvallur district, learnt that she would be making a visit to IIT-Madras this month, she simply could not contain her joy. She was one of the students to be selected to make a presentation that would reflect the digital and computer literacy skills that she had acquired with the help of the Chennai chapter of voluntary organisation Asha for Education.

“Last time, I was not selected to come to IIT, but this time I made it,” says Iniyasri, who is now learning Scratch at a rural training centre (RTC) run by Asha. She showed off her newly acquired skills with a project on the universe at a competition where students from 13 RTCs across Tamil Nadu participated.

Volunteers at Asha Chennai have worked steadily to bring the RTC programme to this point. The programme that started with just two RTCs in 2022 has now grown



into a thriving initiative reaching nearly 1,200 students. The RTCs provide free six-month courses for students from Classes 6 to 12. While every centre begins with digital literacy, students can progress to programming, web development, robotics and AI as their skills develop.

The excitement of the students, most of whom were from government schools in villages, could hardly be contained within the walls of Raman Hall in the IIT-M Research Park during the competition. Rather than allow the high-

pressure environment to dampen their spirits, the students confidently showed their projects to the experts who had come to judge the event. The 18 judges included professionals from Amazon, Ford, Accenture, Cisco, Wipro and several start-up companies. Professors from Rajalakshmi Engineering College and BITS Pilani were also among the judges.

This round in the State capital saw students from 13 centres submit 482 projects across digital literacy, Scratch programming, web



Glimpses from the event held at IIT-Madras. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

development, physical computing, robotics, media editing, JavaScript animations and AI. Of these, 64 projects were selected for presentation at IIT-M. The projects reflected both the students' technical learning and their everyday interests. Scratch projects included games, science topics and environmental themes. Students working on websites tackled subjects ranging from agriculture to food delivery management. Robotics students developed ideas such as cleaning robots, pollution detectors and smart agriculture systems.

Volunteer Rajaraman Krishnan, who has been with Asha Chennai

for over two decades, said that students have been so engaged with the programme that many have continued attending the RTCs over the years. One of them is doing an internship with Asha Chennai now, he added.

Jayavel, one of the judges, said, “The students were impressive, not just because of what they had built, but also because they had learned and understood their projects well and were able to explain their ideas clearly. It is great to see children getting the opportunity to learn technology, experiment with it, and build things on their own.”

Pothys 'Kolusu Kondattam' ends on August 31

Pothys Swarna Mahal, a leading jewellery retailer, has brought tradition and contemporary style with its 'Kolusu Kondattam' mela, held across its showrooms in the state.

Featuring an impressive collection of over 5,000 designs,

the mela offers customers an extensive choice of plain, antique, and designer silver anklets.

Customers can purchase plain silver anklets with no making charges and GST. Customers will pay only for the silver weight and the prevailing silver rate. In addition, antique and

fancy designer anklets are available at a 10 percent discount off the maximum retail price, said a release.

The showrooms are on GST Road, Chromepet; Rukmani Nagar, Poonamallee; C.T.H. Road, Padi; and in Coimbatore, Salem, Tirunelveli, and Trichy.

Special camp by MTC on September 2

The Metropolitan Transport Corporation (MTC) has invited applications from Industrial Training Institute (ITI) students (Mechanic Motor Vehicle, Mechanic Diesel, Electrician, Auto Electrician, Fitter, Turner, Painter, Welder) for a one-year professional acquaintance in ITI, with a stipend of ₹ 14,000 per month.

On September 2, MTC will conduct a special camp from 10 a.m. at the Industrial Training Institute, Chromepet, where students can apply for the one-year training program, said a release from the MTC.

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